being little of a sportsman himself has sent to me to train, for you must know that amongst my *numerous* accomplishments, dog training forms one of the chief. This is not the sporting season so I can not finish his education; but never did I see a dog of such promise. The great matter in this art is to teach them to obey, it does not much matter what they have to obey about, so long as they get the habit. I usually begin by placing their food before them and telling them not to eat it, the dog of course does not understand the meaning of the words, and rushes forward to gobble up his food. I then hit him a slap on his face and drive him back, constantly repeating the words that he may learn them. I then say "eat it" which he does not understand either, so I put the food before him and let him eat it caressing him at the same time. A sensible dog usually learns this lesson in a few days, this one learnt it in three. And when he is fed it is curious to see him crouch down beside his food and look me in the face for permission to eat it. In a week I had taught him to fetch and carry and now he stops, advances, walks behind me or goes before at the word of command. And he has learnt all this without a single blow of the whip; the worst I have done is to slap his face and pull his ears. I believe it is a great mistake to give dogs severe beatings: sometimes no doubt it is necessary particularly with spaniels, but indiscriminate beating discourages them and makes them stupid. I believe that two severe beatings would be enough to spoil the dog I am training. Dogs differ in their dispositions just as much as children, and they ought (the dogs I mean) to like their work. As the quail and partridge season has not begun I can not go much further with Zunboor's education just now. Zunboor is the name of the dog and is Persian for Bee.

I have received yours of the 18th April. I like the Last of the Barons much, it is certainly one of Bulwers best. It was new in Persia and I sent it to my friends at Tehran who had not read it. Indeed now we get very few new books in Persia. You seem to think Galignani[72] a bad newspaper: it is so good a one that I think it not improbable that if ever I settle in England and can afford to take a daily paper I shall take it in; it gives extracts from both sides and with great fairness and is the only English paper we have in Tabreez except the "Illustrated London News" and "Punch." We have several French papers "Debâts" "Siécle" "National" etc. and Constantinople and Smyrna papers also in French, and seldom worth reading except for the Indian news. They are put under a strict "surveillance" by the Turkish govt so that they can not publish any news about Turkey, that is to say the truth.

[72] *Galignani's Messenger* was an English daily published in Paris. From 1890–1895 it was published in London under the name "Daily Messenger." The Library has scattered numbers and runs of the Paris edition from 1823 to 1884.

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